



**Georgian Court University
Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program (CTP) Application**

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1. Brief Overview or Abstract of Program Model

The Transition and Career Studies (TCS) program at Georgian Court University (GCU) will provide students with intellectual disabilities (ID) with an inclusive university experience.

Mission Statement

The mission of the Transition and Career Studies Program is to provide an inclusive and comprehensive residential four-year course of study that supports students with intellectual disabilities who seek to continue academic, career/technical, and independent living instruction in order to obtain competitive integrated employment. TCS offers a university-sanctioned certificate as evidence of the completion of this rigorous and comprehensive inclusive higher education course of study.

Definition of Intellectual Disability:

In order to participate in TCS, students must manifest ID as defined by the Higher Education Act, which defines a student with ID as a student:

- (A) With a cognitive impairment, characterized by significant limitations in
 - (i) intellectual and cognitive functioning; and
 - (ii) adaptive behavior as expressed in conceptual, social, and practical adaptive skills; and
- (B) Who is currently, or was formerly, eligible for a free appropriate public education under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act.

Program Summary:

This is a 121-credit non-degree certificate program. Students will complete three types of courses. Courses will be graded A-F, but will not be awarded college credit. The three types of courses are:

- (A) Standard GCU courses taught on an inclusive model, with accommodations and modifications.
- (B) Courses designed specifically for the program, and which provide academic and social/emotional support; and
- (C) Career and practicum/internship courses.

Upon successful completion of the program, graduates of the program will be awarded a GCU Board of Trustees approved Certificate of Completion.

The program is a four-year residential course of study. Students will live in the university residence halls and will have full access to student support services and to the activities, organizations, and services of student life. In addition, TCS students will be supported through a robust peer mentoring program, as well as by a staff of professionals dedicated to their academic, campus life, and vocational support.

2. *Detailed description of how the program meets all of the definitional components of a Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP), as outlined below:*

- a. The CTP is designed to support students with ID who are seeking to continue **academic, career and technical**, and **independent living** instruction at an institution of higher education in order to prepare for **gainful employment**;

The TCS curriculum is designed with the following goals:

- To strengthen students' academic skills through a course of study based on a liberal learning model;
- To support students in developing independent living skills;
- To support students in social/emotional development; and
- To support students in development of career/technical skills and vocational exploration, with a goal of competitive integrated employment

Academic Skills

The portion of the curriculum that specifically addresses academic skills development is the set of 48 credits of GCU coursework based on the Bridge General Education Program. The Bridge Program is designed to achieve the undergraduate student learning goals, listed below with their learning outcomes:

Goal 1: Foundational Knowledge of Human Cultures and the Physical and Natural World Learning Outcome:

- Students will demonstrate the ability to apply foundational knowledge in the arts, humanities, languages, mathematics, natural sciences and social sciences.

Goal 2: Intellectual and Practical Skills

Learning Outcomes: Students will demonstrate competence in

- Critical and creative thinking, grounded in inquiry, analysis, and synthesis of information
- Written and oral communication
- Quantitative literacy
- Information literacy
- Teamwork and problem solving

Goal 3: Personal and Social Responsibility

Learning Outcomes: Students will demonstrate

- Ethical reasoning
- Global awareness and respect for diverse cultural perspectives
- Knowledge of the university's mission and Mercy charism
- Civic knowledge—local/global

Goal 4: Integrative Learning

Learning Outcome:

- Students will demonstrate the ability to make connections among courses in multiple disciplines, as well as between their experiences inside and outside the classroom.

To support TCS students in their academic coursework, students will participate in an academic seminar every semester, along with courses that provide developmentally appropriate training as well as support for executive functioning. In the academic seminar, students will be encouraged to make contact with academic supports that are available to typically-enrolled and TCS students

alike, such as the Academic Development and Support Center, the Writing Center, and the Math Lounge.

Independent Living Skills

The Campus Life Coordinator has primary responsibility for ensuring that students are integrating appropriately into residential life. The fact that the program is fully residential means that students will necessarily develop a measure of independence. A peer-mentoring program will provide support initially as students enter the program, and will be gradually reduced and/or eliminated as students develop independent living competencies.

Every semester, all students take a campus life seminar, which will ensure that the students are partaking appropriately of campus life activities, and which will also provide a venue for developmentally appropriate instruction in independent living skills (e.g., laundry, public transportation). Peer mentors and the Campus Life Coordinator will support students in acquiring independent living skills.

Social/Emotional Development

To ensure that students are integrating socially, coursework that focuses on social/emotional development is front-loaded in the program: A course on relationships and a course on collaborative community living, both in the first year, will establish the foundation for social integration during the program. Peer mentors will also provide support for social activities, accompanying TCS students to social events as needed.

Our Counseling Center can provide additional support to students as needed; the Director of the Counseling Center will teach the relationships course in the first semester. This will ensure that students are aware of the Counseling Center and have access to its services.

Careers and Vocational Development

The Vocational Coordinator has primary responsibility for students' development of technical/career skills and vocational planning. A major component of the TCS program is career exploration, preparation, and experience. Students will participate in a sequence of developmentally appropriate courses, on-campus practica, and off-campus internships.

- TCS130: Personal Discovery (Career Exploration; 3 credits spring Y1)
- TCS131: Career Readiness (3 credits fall Y2)
- TCS230: TCS Practicum (12 credits total, 3 credits taken each fall and spring Y2 & Y3)
- TCS430: TCS Internship (12 credits total, 6 credits taken fall and spring Y4)

Peer mentors will support vocational experiences under the supervision of the vocational coordinator. We are in the process of developing a menu of industry-valued credentials that students can choose to partake of, according to their vocational interests. In addition, we have contracted with Best Buddies to provide follow-along services to our graduates in their vocational development post-graduation.

- b. The CTP is delivered to students physically attending the institution;
All students in TCS will be residential students, living in the university's residence halls during the fall and spring semesters. TCS-exclusive courses will be offered face to face (within the constraints of COVID-19 related regulations). The majority of GCU general education courses are offered face-to-face or using a hybrid model, but some courses are fully virtual, using a

synchronous or asynchronous model. TCS students may elect to take such courses, depending on their abilities and preferences, but the majority of their courses will be face-to-face.

- c. The CTP includes an advising and curriculum structure;

TCS students will have a faculty academic advisor, who will participate with TCS staff in a team advising approach. Academic advising will be the responsibility of the faculty advisor, but will be informed by input from the Program Coordinator, Academic Coordinator, and Vocational Coordinator. The TCS staff will assist the students in the mechanics of registration and course selection.

The curriculum structure of the TCS program is based on the GCU Bridge General Education program, which has a series of subject areas: Academic writing, quantitative analysis, history, literature, philosophy, visual and performing arts, culture/global studies, natural sciences, social sciences, religious studies, ethics, and gender studies. In addition, the Bridge program has three general-education courses: a first-year seminar, a cornerstone course, and a capstone course. TCS students will complete 48 credits of coursework following the Bridge program requirements, with courses taught using an inclusive model with accommodations and modifications. The sole exception in this regard is GEN101 (see below), which will have a separate section for TCS students. The reason for this is that GEN101 focuses heavily on requirements for graduation, which are different for TCS students vs. typically-enrolled students.

Any course satisfying the Bridge General Education requirement may be taken by TCS students, based on the abilities and interests of the student. A small group of courses are required of all students, but in the other categories there are several choices. Students will select courses based on their interests and abilities through a person-centered advising process.

Required of all students:

- General Education: These three courses are required of all GCU students
 - GEN101 Pathway to the Bridge, our first-semester seminar
 - GEN199 Discovering Self in the Universe, our cornerstone general education course
 - GEN400 Visioning a Future, our general education capstone
- Composition: EN111 Academic Writing and Research I
- Philosophy: PL245 Philosophical Inquiry
- Gender Studies: WS311 Shaping Lives: Women and Gender

Categories that allow choices of courses:

- Literature
- Quantitative reasoning
- History
- Visual & performing arts
- Culture & global studies
- Natural sciences
- Social sciences (2 courses)
- Religious studies
- Ethics

Students in the TCS program will be guided to select courses based on a person-centered planning process, identifying coursework dependent on the student's goals, interests, and abilities. Courses will typically be selected from courses that satisfy the Bridge general education requirements, with one exception: typically enrolled students are required to take a modern language requirement, but TCS students may also satisfy the culture and global studies requirement by taking multicultural psychology, world music, or cultural anthropology. In addition to the 48 credits represented by the Bridge General Education program, students will select 9 credits of elective coursework, which can be from any GCU courses.

Faculty teaching GCU courses in the TCS program will undergo training in the models of inclusive education and will be supported by the Program Coordinator and the Academic Coordinator, who will work with the faculty to identify appropriate accommodations and modifications.

The remaining coursework for TCS students can be divided into two major categories: Courses providing academic and social/emotional support and career related coursework.

Courses Providing Academic and Social/Emotional Support (34 Credits):

Students will participate in a campus life seminar and an academic seminar every semester, with developmentally appropriate training as well as support for executive functioning and social activity. In addition, there will be courses to support social and emotional development in the first year. In the senior year, a transition seminar will support the transition out of the college experience.

- TCS100: First-Year Campus Life Seminar (2 credits fall Year 1)
- TCS101: First-Year Campus Life Support (2 credits spring Year 1)
- TCS110: First-Year Academic Seminar I (2 credits fall Y1)
- TCS111: First-Year Academic Seminar II (2 credits spring Y1)
- TCS120: Personal Discovery (3 credits fall Y1)
- TCS140: Relationships, Health, & Wellness (3 credits fall Y1)
- TCS141: Collaborative Community Living (2 credits spring Y1)
- TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar (1 credit fall Y2, 1 credit spring Y2, 1 credit fall Y3, 1 credit spring Y3)
- TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar (2 credits fall Y2, 2 credits spring Y2, 2 credits fall Y3, 2 credits spring Y3)
- TCS400: Senior Transition I (2 credits fall Y4)
- TCS401: Senior Transition II (2 credits spring Y4)
- TCS410: Academic Seminar IV (1 credit fall Y4, 1 credit spring Y4)

Career and Practicum/Internship Courses (30 Credits):

A major component of a TPSID program is career exploration, preparation, and experience. Students will participate in a sequence of developmentally appropriate courses, on-campus practica, and off-campus internships.

- TCS130: Career Exploration (3 credits spring Y1)
- TCS131: Career Readiness (3 credits fall Y2)
- TCS230: TCS Practicum (12 credits total, 3 credits taken each fall and spring Y2 & Y3)
- TCS430: TCS Internship (12 credits total, 6 credits taken fall and spring Y4)

A four-year degree map is depicted in Table I.

Table I: Degree Map for Transition and Career Studies Program

Year 1			
Fall Semester	Credit	Spring Semester	Credit
GEN101: First-Year Seminar	2	GEN199: General Education Cornerstone	3
EN111: Academic Writing	3	Visual & Performing Arts	3
TCS100: First-Year Campus Life Seminar	2	TCS101: First-Year Campus Life Support	2
TCS110: First-Year Academic Seminar I	2	TCS111: First-Year Academic Seminar II	2
TCS120: Personal Discovery	3	TCS130: Career Exploration	3
TCS140: Relationships, Health, Wellness	3	TCS141: Collaborative Community Living	2
<i>Semester Total</i>	15	<i>Semester Total</i>	15
Year 2			
Fall Semester	Credit	Spring Semester	Credit
Social Science 1	3	Religious Studies	3
Literature	3	Culture & Global Studies	3
TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar	1	TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar	1
TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar	2	TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar	2
TCS230: TCS Practicum	3	TCS230: TCS Practicum	3
TCS131: Career Readiness	3	GCU ELECTIVE	3
<i>Semester Total</i>	15	<i>Semester Total</i>	15
Year 3			
Fall Semester	Credit	Spring Semester	Credit
PL245: Philosophical Inquiry	3	PL354: Bioethics	3
Quantitative Analysis	3	Natural Science	4
TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar	1	TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar	1
TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar	2	TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar	2
TCS230: TCS Practicum	3	TCS230: TCS Practicum	3
GCU ELECTIVE	3	GCU ELECTIVE	3
<i>Semester Total</i>	15	<i>Semester Total</i>	16
Year 4			
Fall Semester	Credit	Spring Semester	Credit
WS311: Gender Studies	3	GEN400: General Education Capstone	3
History	3	Social Science 2	3
TCS400: Senior Transition I	2	TCS401: Senior Transition II	2
TCS410: Senior Academic Seminar	1	TCS410: Senior Academic Seminar	1
TCS430: TCS Internship	6	TCS430: TCS Internship	6
<i>Semester Total</i>	15	<i>Semester Total</i>	15

- d. The CTP requires students with intellectual disabilities to have at least one-half of their participation in the program, as determined by the institution, focus on academic components through one or more of the following activities:

NOTE: MAKE SURE TO address EACH section

- i. Taking credit-bearing courses with students without disabilities.

TCS students will not earn college credit for their coursework.

- ii. Auditing or otherwise participating in courses with students without disabilities for which the student does not receive regular academic credit.

TCS students take 57 credits of GCU courses. The courses will be graded A-F, but will not convey GCU credit. All of the courses will be taught on an inclusive model except for GEN101, which will have a separate section for TCS students.

A total of 55 credits of their coursework will be courses with students without disabilities for which the student does not receive regular academic credit.

- iii. Taking non-credit-bearing, non-degree courses with students without disabilities.

TCS students do not take non-credit-bearing, non-degree courses with students without disabilities.

- iv. Participating in internships or work-based training in settings with individuals without disabilities.

TCS students complete two years of practicum placements in a work-study format on campus, to allow opportunities for exploration of different work environments. This represents 12 credits of the program. In the final year of the program, TCS students complete an off-campus internship for an additional 12 credits of the program. All the internship placements will be in settings with individuals without disabilities.

The program satisfies the requirement that at least half of the program be under one of the four categories listed above. Of 121 credits, only 45 credits do not satisfy the requirement of inclusive education. GEN101 will not be taught inclusively, and TCS students take 43 credits of courses that are specific to the TCS program, and for which the only students without disabilities in the class will be peer mentors. These non-credit-bearing, non-degree courses are front-loaded in the first year of the program, diminishing to three credits per semester in the last three years.

- e. The CTP provides students with ID opportunities to be socially and academically integrated with non-disabled students to the maximum extent possible.

TCS students will live in the GCU residence halls side-by-side with non-disabled students. They will have access to the student life activities and events, and they may participate in student governance. A Campus Life Coordinator, one of the TCS professional staff, will work with the TCS students to ensure that they are being fully integrated into the life of the campus. Our robust program of peer mentoring will include mentor support for campus life activities. Unified Sports is already part of student life, and we have initiated the first steps for establishing a chapter of Best Buddies on GCU campus, but TCS students will have access to all the student life programming.

In terms of academic integration, TCS students will take two or more GCU courses every semester, with all but one of those courses using an integrated instructional model. Academic peer mentors will support TCS students in their integrated courses, which constitute almost two-thirds of the academic experience.

3) *The institutional policy for determining whether a student enrolled in the program is making satisfactory academic progress (SAP);*

SAP is reviewed after fall, spring, and summer grades are posted. Students must meet two requirements in order to make SAP, reflecting the number of credits successfully completed and the grades awarded. Students must complete at least two-thirds (67%) of attempted credits, and they must have an overall grade-point average above a minimum requirement. The minimum requirement increases as students approach completion of the program.

- If they have attempted 1-30 credits, their GPA must be at least 1.8
- If they have attempted 31-60 credits, their GPA must be at least 1.9
- If they have attempted over 60 credits, their GPA must be at least 2.0

These requirements for SAP are identical to the requirements for undergraduates in our degree programs.

Repeating a Course: A course retaken to improve a grade will result in only the higher grade being calculated in the academic average. The lower grade will remain on the academic transcript but will not be included in the grade point average or in the earned credit total. Repeated courses shall be taken at Georgian Court, unless special permission is given by the program director.

Academic Warning: Any student whose cumulative or term GPA falls below 2.0 who is not placed on academic probation or strict academic probation, or who is not dismissed from the university, may receive an official academic warning notice.

Academic Probation: Students on academic probation continue as fully enrolled students at Georgian Court University, but are limited to 16 credits per term while on academic probation. In addition, students are required to meet monthly with academic support staff and participate in designated workshops. Students may be placed on academic probation if they fall below the minimum requirements for SAP.

- Students who are on academic probation and have shown improvement, but who have not yet reached the minimum acceptable requirements for SAP may remain on academic probation.
- Students who have been on academic probation for at least one semester and who have failed to show improvement, or whose cumulative or term GPA has fallen, may be placed on strict academic probation. See “Strict Academic Probation” below.

Strict Academic Probation: Students on strict academic probation continue as fully enrolled students at Georgian Court University, but are limited to 13 credits per term while on strict academic probation. In addition, students are required to meet twice monthly with academic support staff and participate in designated workshops.

- Students whose cumulative GPA is below 1.7 or term GPA is below 1.5 may be placed on strict academic probation.
- Students who are on strict academic probation but who have not yet reached the minimum acceptable requirements for SAP may remain on strict academic probation for additional semesters. If they have shown some improvement, they may be placed on academic probation instead.
- Students may also be placed on strict academic probation if they have been on academic probation for at least one semester and failed to show improvement, or if their cumulative or term GPA falls while they are on probation. See “Academic Probation” above.

Academic Dismissal: Students will be dismissed from the university if:

- their cumulative GPA falls below 1.0, or if they earn a term GPA of 0 during a semester in which they have taken at least 6 credits; or
- they have spent two semesters on academic probation and/or strict academic probation, and the student has not shown improvement; or

- they have spent three semesters on academic probation and/or strict academic probation and have not achieved the minimum acceptable requirements for SAP.

Students have the option to appeal probationary status and dismissal. Students are notified of their warning/probationary status/dismissal in writing and by email. In that communication, they are instructed concerning the nature and consequences of their status, and they are advised that they may appeal the decision. The Academic Standards Committee reviews all appeals in consultation with academic support staff, who are invited to present input concerning the student's case. The following factors may lead to a reduction in the level of the status (e.g., from dismissal to strict probation) or the probationary status could be removed entirely. Mitigating factors that contribute to the Committee granting appeals include, but are not limited to: (1) evidence of external factors (e.g., illness, family crisis) which contributed to poor academic performance, and which are now resolved; (2) evidence of a clear and viable plan for achieving academic success.

The following is a sample of the letter by which students are notified of their status and of the appeal process:

Date

Student Name

Major: *Major*

Dear *Student*,

Your academic record from the Spring 2021 semester has been reviewed. The grade point average you have achieved does not meet the requirements for successful academic standing as outlined in the Undergraduate Catalog. As such, your academic status is **Strict Probation** for the Fall 2021 semester. The conditions of Strict Probation status is listed below and must be adhered to.

1. For the Fall Semester you are limited to **13** credits. Use Self-Service to change your credit load.
2. You must have an individual appointment with a program specialist **8** times over the course of the semester.
3. You must participate in tutoring, Writing Center, Math Lounge, workshops and/or other campus resources at the request of your program specialist or academic advisor.

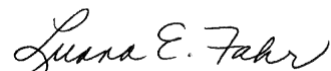
The probationary status is not a punishment, rather a planned approach to help you achieve your academic goals. Failure to improve your grade point average in the probationary period may result in your dismissal from the University. Adhering to the conditions of the Strict Probation status is your best approach to improving your academic standing.

Enclosed you will find an Agreement with the terms of the Strict Probation status. Please sign and return the Agreement to the Office of Student Success by **DATE** or your standing at Georgian Court could be in jeopardy.

If you wish to appeal this status and/or credit limit, submit a letter of appeal and the signed Agreement to my attention at success@georgian.edu by **DATE** to be reviewed by the Academic Standards Committee.

I encourage you to use the services and support made available through the Student Success Office, the Academic Development and Support Center, TRIO-Student Support Services or the EOF Office, if appropriate, to prepare your appeal or complete the Agreement.

Sincerely,



Luana E. Fahr
Director of Student Success and Retention

Enclosure

cc: Registrar, Academic Advisor, Program Director, Student Success

Students who are designated as failing to make satisfactory academic progress are similarly notified that they may appeal the designation using the Satisfactory Academic Progress Appeal Form. The form is available at

<https://georgian.edu/wp-content/uploads/Satisfactory-Academic-Progress-Appeal-Form.pdf>

Maximum Time Frame for Program Completion:

As with the undergraduate degree programs, the maximum time frame for program completion is based on the number of credits completed, and the maximum time frame during which a student is expected to finish the Transition and Career Studies program may not exceed 150 percent of the published length of the program. Thus, a TCS student is allowed a maximum of 181 credit hours to complete degree requirements.

- 4) *The number of weeks of instructional time and the number of semester or quarter credit hours or clock hours in the program, including the equivalent credit or clock hours associated with noncredit or reduced credit courses or activities;*

The TCS program follows the same 14-week calendar as the undergraduate degree programs, fall and spring semesters. The TCS program includes 121 credits of coursework. Although the TCS students do not earn college credit for their courses, the course credits determine the student's course load and are related to clock hours as explained below (The following paragraph is from the GCU Undergraduate Catalog; the policy for TCS is the same as for typically-enrolled students).

GCU Policy: Credit-Hour Assignments for Courses

A credit hour is the amount of work represented in intended learning outcomes and verified by evidence of student achievement that approximates not less than (1) one hour (50 minutes) of classroom or direct faculty instruction and a minimum of two hours (100 minutes) of out-of-class student work each week for approximately 15 weeks for one semester, or the equivalent amount of work over a different amount of time, or (2) at least an equivalent amount of work as required in (1) for other activities such as lab work, internships, practica, and studio work. Faculty members in academic departments propose the amount of credit hours to be assigned to each new course to the dean and appropriate curriculum committee based on the preceding definition of a credit hour. New course proposals are accompanied by sample syllabi/course outlines that show the amount of work, intended learning outcomes, and how achievement of the learning outcomes will be assessed. The amount of credit hours approved for a new course by the dean and curriculum committee is then reviewed by the provost, who has the final authority for assigning credit hours to a course. This policy applies to all courses, regardless of mode of delivery.

The TCS program is four years, fall and spring semesters, with 15-16 credits of coursework each semester.

This is a full-time residential program. The clock hours for the program include the following:

Year 1:

- 15 clock hours of course instruction per week
- 5-10 hours of supplemental academic support per week
- 12-15 hours of recreational and social activities with other GCU undergraduates per week

Using the minimum of each range, this leads to a weekly total of 32 hours.

32 hours X 30 weeks = 960 hours in Year 1

Years 2 & 3:

- 13 clock hours of course instruction per week
- 6-8 hours of practicum experience per week (minimum of 90 hours per semester)
- 5-10 hours of supplemental academic support per week
- 12-15 hours of recreational and social activities with other GCU undergraduates per week

Using the minimum of each range, this leads to a weekly total of 36 hours

$36 \text{ hours} \times 30 \text{ weeks} \times 2 \text{ years} = 2,160 \text{ hours total in Years 2 \& 3}$

Year 4:

- 10 clock hours of course instruction per week
- 18-21 hours of internship experience per week
- 5-10 hours of supplemental academic support per week
- 12-15 hours of recreational and social activities with other GCU undergraduates per week

Using the minimum of each range, this leads to a weekly total of 45 hours

$45 \text{ hours} \times 30 \text{ weeks} = 1,350 \text{ hours in Year 4}$

Grand total: $960 + 2,160 + 1,350 = 4,470$ hours total over the four years of the full-time residential program.

5) *A description of the educational credential offered (e.g., degree or certificate) and identified outcome or outcomes established by the institution for all students enrolled in the program;*

The educational credential GCU will offer through its CTP will be entitled the Transition and Career Studies Certificate of Completion.

The mission of the Transition and Career Studies Program is to provide an inclusive and comprehensive residential four-year course of study that supports students with intellectual disabilities who seek to continue academic, career/technical, and independent living instruction in order to obtain competitive integrated employment. TCS offers a university-sanctioned certificate as evidence of the completion of this rigorous and comprehensive inclusive higher education course of study.

Minimum Requirements for the Transition and Career Studies Certificate of Completion: Students must attain passing grades (D or better) in all their courses and satisfy the requirements for satisfactory academic progress.

6) A copy of the letter or notice sent to the institution's accrediting agency informing the agency of its comprehensive transition and postsecondary program. The letter or notice must include a description of the items in paragraphs (1) through (4) of this section.

Below are the letter sent to Middle States Commission on Higher Education (MSCHE) and the response from MSCHE acknowledging receipt of the letter.



GEORGIAN COURT UNIVERSITY
THE MERCY UNIVERSITY OF NEW JERSEY

Office of the Associate Provost
for Academic Program Development
900 Lakewood Avenue
Lakewood, NJ 08701-2697

Tel: 732.987.2373
Fax: 732.987.2021
www.georgian.edu

Dr. Sean McKittrick
Vice President
Middle States Commission on Higher Education
3624 Market Street, Suite 2 West
Philadelphia, PA 19104

June 01, 2021

Dear Dr. McKittrick:

Georgian Court University (GCU) is submitting an application to the US Department of Education to begin a Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary Program (CTP) for individuals with intellectual disabilities, called the Transition and Career Studies Program (TCS). This program is supported by a federal grant (Award # P407A200038) and will admit its first cohort in Fall 2021.

The CTP application requires that we inform the MSCHE concerning the following aspects of the program:

- How the program meets all of the definitional components of a Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP);
 - Whether the CTP is delivered to students physically attending the institution;
 - The advising and curriculum structure;
 - The degree to which the program includes academic and social interaction with typically-enrolled peers;
- The satisfactory academic progress policy;
- The number of weeks of instructional time and the number of semester or quarter credit hours or clock hours in the program; and
- A description of the educational credential offered.

How the program meets all of the definitional components of a Comprehensive Transition Program (CTP):

The four-year residential program will admit 5-6 students each year. Pursuant to the grant objectives, students must meet the definition of intellectual disability, aged 18-25 when they matriculate. All TCS students will reside in GCU's residence halls, and coursework will be offered in face-to-face and hybrid modalities. TCS students will have full access to the social life of the campus, including campus life events, clubs and student organizations.

TCS students will be advised by the Faculty Director of the program and supported by four full-time staff members: the Program Coordinator, the Academic Coordinator, the Vocational Coordinator, and the Campus life Coordinator. In addition, a robust peer mentoring program will provide academic and social support to TCS students. In addition to these supports TCS students may use the same academic supports as our typically-enrolled students, including a writing center, a math tutoring center, and the Academic and Student Support Center, which provides general academic support. The Counseling Center is also available to TCS students as needed. The Academic Coordinator will work with Georgian Court's faculty to determine what accommodations and modifications of GCU courses are necessary to facilitate student success. These accommodations and modifications will be developed using a person-centered planning process.

The curriculum has been approved by (1) the School of Arts and Sciences Curriculum Committee, (2) the Faculty Assembly (the entity that comprises the whole of the faculty), (3) the Academic and Student Affairs Committee of the Board of Trustees, and (4) the Board of Trustees. It includes three broad categories of courses:

- GCU general education courses and electives taught on an inclusive model, with both TCS students and typically-enrolled students (55 credits);
- TCS courses that are exclusively for TCS students and which provide academic and social/emotional support (36 credits)
- TCS courses that are exclusively for TCS students and which provide career development, plus practicum and internship experiences that will include both TCS students and typically-enrolled students (30 credits).

All but 45 credits of the coursework will include both TCS students and typically-enrolled students, so this program exceeds the requirements for inclusive education.

The Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy:

The TCS program will use the same satisfactory academic progress policy as the undergraduate program. Students must successfully complete a minimum of 2/3 of attempted coursework, and they must maintain a minimum GPA that increases as the students accrue credits:

- 1.8 when students have attempted 1-30 credits;
- 1.9 when students have attempted 31-60 credits; and
- 2.0 when students have attempted over 60 credits.

Students in this program will not earn GCU university credit for their coursework; credits refer to attempted course load, not to credits earned.

The number of weeks of instructional time and the number of semester or quarter credit hours or clock hours in the program:

The TCS program runs during the regular 15-week fall and spring semesters, and students complete a total of 121 credits for the program, with 15-16 credits each semester for four years. The definition of a credit hour is identical to the definition in the undergraduate catalog: A credit hour is the amount of work represented in intended learning outcomes and verified by evidence of student achievement that approximates not less than (1) one hour (50 minutes) of classroom or direct faculty instruction and a minimum of two hours (100 minutes) of out-of-class student work

each week for approximately 15 weeks for one semester, or the equivalent amount of work over a different amount of time, or (2) at least an equivalent amount of work as required in (1) for other activities such as lab work, internships, practica, and studio work.

A description of the educational credential offered:

Upon completion of the TCS program, students will have made progress in academics, developed career-relevant skills and abilities, increased independent living capacity, and progressed toward the establishment of a career. Successful completion of the TCS program coursework will lead to a GCU Board of Trustees sanctioned non-credit Certificate of Completion.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,



Michael F. Gross, Ph.D.
Associate Provost for Academic Program Development
ALO for MSCHE

cc: Dr. Susan E.O. Field, Professor of Psychology & Director, Transition and Career Studies Program

Dr. Joseph R. Marbach, President



June 10, 2021

Dr. Joseph Marbach, President
Georgian Court University
900 Lakewood Avenue
Lakewood, NJ 08701-2697

Dear President Marbach,

This letter will confirm notification from your institution regarding the Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) program to be offered by Georgian Court University.

The Middle States Commission on Higher Education (MSCHE) does not approve specific programs. However, the Commission recognizes the institution's prerogative to develop and offer new programs or modify existing programs within its established guidelines and procedures that are consistent with its mission to meet the needs of its students. Documentation has been provided which, within the context of institutional mission, compares the content and curriculum of this program to other program offerings at Georgian Court University. Based on our review, this program does not represent a significant departure in content or delivery from other degree or non-degree programs that are offered by Georgian Court University. Therefore, a separate substantive change review by MSCHE is not required.

Public information regarding Georgian Court University, its current Statement of Accreditation Status which indicates the credential levels and educational sites included within the scope of the university's accreditation is available on our [website](#).

In conclusion, the Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) program offered by Georgian Court University will be included within the scope of the institution's MSCHE accreditation when it is offered. As such, the CTP program will be reviewed during the institution's next self-study evaluation in 2027-2028.

If you have any questions regarding the information contained in this letter, please feel free to contact me at 267-284-5030 or via email at dbonner@msche.org.

Sincerely,

Diana E. Bonner
Assistant Director for Institutional Support Services

c: Dr. Sean McKittrick, Vice President for, Institutional Field Relations
Dr. Michael Gross, Associate Provost for Academic Program Development
Dr. Susan E.O. Field, Professor of Psychology and Director of Transition and Career Studies

Appendix: Selected Course Descriptions

The following are course descriptions of the TCS courses providing academic, social/emotional, and vocational support for TCS students. These courses are exclusively for TCS students.

Course	Credits	Description
TCS100: First-Year Campus Life Seminar	2	This seminar is designed to support first-year TCS students in acclimating to student life on GCU campus and to provide them with the necessary guidance needed to be successful campus community participants. It provides bi-weekly sessions with the TCS Student Life Program Specialist focusing on specific areas of need and provides instruction in areas that are critical to maintaining a productive and safe college experience. This first-year seminar provides supplemental instruction and guidance so that TCS students can access the resources and opportunities of an inclusive university campus and obtain accommodations/modifications, if necessary. Students will be provided with the knowledge, skills, and understanding necessary to fully engage in campus life activities, access campus resources and maintain a safe and secure college experience. Required of and restricted to first-year TCS students.
TCS101: First-Year Campus Life Support	2	This seminar is designed to provide continued support to first-year TCS students, reinforcing and building on the material presented in TCS100. It provides bi-weekly sessions with the TCS Student Life Program Specialist focusing on specific areas of need and provides reinforcement of areas that are critical to maintaining a productive and safe college experience. Required of and restricted to first-year TCS students. Prerequisite: TCS100.
TCS110: First-Year Academic Seminar I	2	This specialized first-year seminar is designed to provide initial support to TCS students regarding university academics and campus orientation. It provides first-year students with ongoing guidance and review within a classroom structure. This seminar will encourage students to further develop their skills in executive functioning, self-advocacy, self-determination, and study skills. It provides ongoing opportunities for advisement and support of organization, time management and study skills. Required of and restricted to first-year TCS students.
TCS111: First-Year Academic Seminar II	2	This is the second component of a two-part specialized first-year seminar designed to provide initial support to TCS students regarding university academics and campus orientation. It provides first-year students with ongoing guidance and review within a classroom structure. This seminar will encourage students to further develop their skills in executive functioning, self-advocacy, self-determination, and study skills. It provides a daily

		opportunity for advisement and organization, time management and study skills. In addition, a component of this course is the identification and implementation of additional assistive and instructional technology. Required of and restricted to first-year TCS students.
TCS120: Personal Discovery	3	This course guides students' exploration into self-concept, establishing a framework to identify individual strengths, abilities, talents and opportunities for improvement. Each student will develop a person-centered life plan through research-based processes that will be reviewed and used throughout the program. In addition, students will focus on approaches to problem-solving, choice-making and goal-setting. Central to this course is the development of skills in supported decision-making as a means of self-determination. Required of and restricted to first-year TCS students.
TCS130: Career Exploration	3	This course engages students in the process of identifying, planning and pursuing a career and understanding the options for employment within that career sector. The course begins with the parameters of the "world of work" including the various options available for work within specific careers. Students engage in a systematic self-assessment that focuses on career exploration as it relates to their unique skills, interests, talents and values. Instruction will develop life skills such as exploring personal work interests and preferences, researching employment sectors and career paths, résumé writing, and job interviewing. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their first year. Prerequisite: TCS120.
TCS131: Career Readiness	3	This course compliments the students' first on-campus practicum experiences and serves as a context to reflect on the soft skills of work and the role of an employee. Students will engage in classroom instruction that includes the responsibilities associated with work; mediating the relationship between an employee and both authority / management and peer workers; and the rights of workers. Associated with these workplace readiness areas, students will be instructed in skills and behaviors of a successful employee such as time management, problem-solving, working with the public, and transportation. Lastly, the course will address the process of securing entry-level positions that have upward mobility and associating this with the students' individual career area choices. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their second year. Prerequisite: TCS130.
TCS140: Relationships, Health, Wellness	3	This course will introduce students to the basic concepts necessary to form successful relationships and exercise a healthy lifestyle. Students will explore aspects of physical, nutritional, mental, emotional, social, spiritual and environmental health both in the context of the campus environment and beyond. The importance of forming and

		maintaining relationships as a component of achieving a healthy lifestyle will be emphasized. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their first year.
TCS141: Collaborative Community Living	2	This course supports students as they continue their journey as independent college students living and working within the context of their residence, classrooms, and overall campus community. The themes and content of the prerequisite course (TCS140) regarding building relationships and developing healthy habits will be further explored within their role as members of the college community. GCU policies, protocols and resources will be reviewed in regards to the students' emerging social and professional relationships with peers, professors and others. In addition, students will develop skills in bridging the gap between their role as a member of GCU community and a member of their family / home community so that their evolving independence can be appropriately exercised at home. Students will engage in identifying current issues and discuss solutions to their efforts to be included within college student community activities. Overall, the primary focus of this course will be to provide students with specific skills and strategies that will prepare them to have a safe, healthy, engaging, and independent college experience, and for life post-graduation. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their first year. Prerequisite: TCS140.
TCS200: Advanced Campus Life Seminar	1	This seminar is designed to continue to support TCS students with the knowledge, skills and understanding necessary to advance within the student life and overall college community outside of the academic arena. It provides a weekly session with the TSC Student Life Program Specialist focusing on specific areas of need. Each semester the course adds a specialized focus area of social/emotional development that is determined by cohort need. The Student Life Program Specialist will design seminar expectations to include expectations and assignments. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their sophomore and junior years. Repeatable up to 4 credits. Prerequisite: TCS101.
TCS210: Advanced Academic Seminar	2	This specialized seminar series is designed to provide TCS Sophomores and Juniors with continued support regarding college academics and campus orientation. It provides ongoing guidance and review within a classroom structure. This seminar encourages students to further develop their skills in executive functioning, self-advocacy, self-determination, and study skills. It provides opportunities for ongoing advisement and for monitoring of organization and time management. In addition, each semester the course adds a specialized focus area that is determined by program/cohort need. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their second and third years. Repeatable for up to 8 credits. Prerequisite: TCS111

TCS230: TCS Practicum	3	The TCS Practicum is a four-semester series that students take across their sophomore and junior years, allowing them to sample a supervised work experience in several employment sectors located on the GCU campus. Students are required to experience at least two different work sectors that may include information technology, retail, business, food service, customer service, service industry, or other areas of campus. The practicum experiences are designed to mirror competitive integrated employment, providing students with real-life work experience in various work environments for the purposes of developing and exercising work-related “soft skills.” Required of and restricted to TCS students in their second and third years. Repeatable for up to 12 credits. Prerequisite: TCS 130
TCS400: Senior Transition I	2	This course addresses the transition from college to an integrated adult life. Using the person-centered planning materials developed over the course of the last three years in the program, students will engage in a formal transition planning process that is augmented by instruction in the support services and other resources to ensure a smooth and successful transition from college. Students’ planning will primarily address the following career/vocational areas: Career path identification, researching potential employers, networking skills, job applications, résumé writing, and interview preparation. Students will begin development of a senior portfolio. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their senior year.
TCS401: Senior Transition II	2	This course addresses the transition from college to an integrated adult life. Using the person-centered planning materials developed over the course of the last three years in the program, students will engage in a formal transition planning process augmented by instruction in the support services and other resources to assure a smooth and successful transition from college. This course is focused on finalizing the student’s person-centered planning and completing the student’s portfolio. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their senior year. Prerequisite: TCS400.
TCS410: Senior Academic Seminar	1	This course provides TCS seniors with limited support and guidance regarding academic classes and other campus-related issues. In addition, seniors are facilitated through topics and issues related to the transition out of college to the adult life with an emphasis on social/emotional factors. Topics include planning and adjustment to life after graduation; maintaining friendships and exercising self-direction. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their senior year. Repeatable for up to 2 credits.
TCS430: TCS Internship	6	The TCS Internship reflects a substantial supervised work experience off-campus in an area of interest to the student.. The Internship is between 18-21 hours per week for two

		semesters. Students must interview for a position and learn to take public / private transportation to and from the campus. In addition, there is a bi-weekly seminar hosted by the Career and Vocational Program Specialist. Required of and restricted to TCS students in their senior year. Repeatable for up to 12 credits. Prerequisite: TCS230
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The following are course descriptions for GCU courses that will be taken by all TCS students.

Course	Credits	Description
GEN101: Pathway to the Bridge (First-year seminar)	2	Students will develop the knowledge, skills, and values necessary for success at Georgian Court University. They will gain an understanding of the university's mission, charism, and heritage. Through a collaborative project, students will execute and reflect on the practices associated with a successful college experience. Enrollment restricted to all first time in college students and transfer students who transfer fewer than 12 credits.
GEN199: Discovering Self in the Universe (General Education Cornerstone)	3	A cornerstone general education course that asks students to explore the Mercy core values of respect and integrity within the framework of commonality, diversity, and symbiosis. Students analyze their identity by investigating the oneness of humanity and the rich complexity of diverse cultures. Students consider, from multiple disciplines, how all of humanity is a part of a much larger story of the universe. It examines the origin and the composition of the universe and humanity's response to its complexity and fragility, beauty and wonder. In this writing intensive course, students develop questions about what it means to be creative, responsible human beings in today's integrally connected global society and dynamic universe. The course is designed to be taken in the spring of the first time in college year or, in the case of transfer students, in the first semester at GCU. Pre/corequisite(s): EN111 or equivalent or EN221.
GEN400: Visioning a Future (General Education Capstone)	3	In light of GCU Mercy core values, this writing intensive capstone course invites students to reflect and analyze how their General Education Program has impacted their understanding of themselves in the world, as well as how their world view has developed. Course readings, service learning, and speakers encourage students to consider key questions of the time. Students contribute toward envisioning the future and humankind's responsibility in helping to shape that future. This involves questions that have emerged from the General Education Program such as how do we contribute to a more compassionate and just world for humankind and the Earth itself? How do we think about just, healthy, and sustainable ways of living and

		working on this planet? Prerequisite(s): Senior status or approval from the director of the General Education Program; GEN199.
EN111: Academic Writing & Research I	3	Practice in the process and production of academic writing and research. Emphasis on the major strategies for organizing expository and persuasive writing, the relationship of the writer and audience, and the use of documented supporting evidence. An argument-based research paper is required and completed under supervision. Basic oral presentation skills are introduced and integrated into class activities. This course fulfills the university writing requirement. Students must earn a grade of C or better to meet general education requirement. Offered yearly. Prerequisite(s): Placement or a grade of C or better in EN106.
PL245: Philosophical Inquiry	3	What is Philosophy? This question seems like any other, yet we are forced to admit that it has no answer, and that perhaps it can never be definitively answered. It is an inescapable fact that all thinking emerges out of a world not of its own making. Like the dawn that follows dusk, philosophy understands reality only after the event. This course traces the history of philosophy as a sustained reflection on that paradox. In this course we will read and critically discuss some of the major texts, arguments and figures that have shaped the self-understanding of the world in which we live. Representative figures may include Plato, Aristotle, Epicurus, Epictetus, St. Augustine, St. Anselm, Aquinas, Descartes, Hume, Kant, Hegel, Nietzsche, James, Wittgenstein, and Kuhn. Prerequisite(s): Grade of C or better in EN111, its equivalent, or EN221.
WS311: Shaping Lives: Women & Gender	3	This interdisciplinary course considers gender as both a critical field of inquiry and as a social construct that influences experiences, relationships, and outcomes of women in society. The course is organized around three main themes: (1) foundations for understanding women and gender; (2) the six institutions that impact and are impacted by women (e.g., work, education, politics); and (3) leadership and activism. Emphasis on the intersection of gender, race, ethnicity, and social class. Prerequisite(s): Junior or senior status.